THE AI WORKFLOW PLAYBOOK

30 Practical ChatGPT Systems

for Small Business, Marketing, Sales & Daily Operations



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30 Practical ChatGPT Systems for Small Business, Marketing, Sales & Daily Operations

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All business examples, names and figures in this book are fictional and for illustration only. This is an educational guide; it does not promise income or growth.

Sources

Statements of fact are supported by the references at the end of the book, with the date each source was checked. Web pages change; confirm current details before relying on them.

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Before you begin

This book is educational. It does not promise income, growth or any specific result. AI tools make mistakes, and their features change often. Every workflow here ends with a human check, and that check is part of the method, not an optional extra. Where this book mentions a feature, verify it in your own account. All example businesses, names and figures are **fictional and for illustration only**.

Research and update note: This edition was written on 7 November 2026 without live verification of current product features, pricing or limits. Workflows rely on plain chat and pasted text, which are the most stable parts of any AI assistant. Before relying on a feature (file upload, saved instructions, memory, web search), check the provider's current help pages.

CHAPTER 1

Practical AI for business: how to think about it

What a chat assistant is good at

A chat assistant such as ChatGPT is strong at **language work on material you give it**: drafting, rewriting, summarizing, sorting, extracting, outlining, brainstorming, explaining and reformatting. It is fast, tireless and never bored by repetitive writing.

What it is bad at

- **Facts it was not given.** It can state wrong things fluently. Never publish a claim you have not checked.
- **Knowing your business.** It knows only what you tell it in the conversation.
- **Judgment and accountability.** Prices, promises, legal wording, medical or financial advice and hiring decisions remain yours.
- **Staying consistent** unless you give it the same instructions each time. That is why this book uses reusable prompts.

The one-line rule

> **AI drafts. You decide.**

Everything in this book applies it: a workflow produces a draft or a structure, and a person checks it before it is used.

The five-part workflow

Each of the 30 workflows is a small version of the same loop:

1. **Input**: gather the real material (notes, reviews, product details).
2. **Prompt**: give the assistant a role, context, task and format.
3. **Draft**: read what comes back.
4. **Check**: use the verification checklist (facts, tone, privacy, promises).
5. **Save**: store the best prompt so next time takes two minutes.

How to read this book

Do not read the 30 workflows in one sitting. Pick the three that match your biggest weekly time-sinks and run them this week. Chapter 12 gives a 30-day order. Appendix A collects every prompt in one place.

How each workflow is laid out

Problem · Outcome · Tools · Steps · Prompt · Example input · Example output · Verify · Mistakes and fixes.

Square brackets like [PRODUCT] mean "replace this with your real information."

What you need

A ChatGPT account (or similar assistant), a place to save prompts (a notes app or document), and your own business material. A spreadsheet app helps in Chapters 9 and 10.

Setting up ChatGPT for these workflows (checked 7 November 2026)

Every workflow in this book works by pasting text into a normal chat. You do not need any special feature. But a few features make the work calmer, and a few settings protect you. Here is what OpenAI's help

pages described when this edition was prepared. Plans, limits and menu names change, so treat this as a checklist of things to look for, not a promise of what your account has.

Projects. OpenAI describes projects as a way to keep related chats, files and instructions together, and says project instructions apply inside that project and take priority over your general custom instructions. A practical use: make one project per area of your business, such as "Marketing", "Customer replies" and "Admin", and put the matching Business Context Block (Workflow 1) in each project's instructions. Then every new chat in that project starts with the right context.

Custom instructions and memory. Custom instructions are text you write once and the assistant reads in every chat. Memory is information the assistant can keep between chats; OpenAI provides settings to view, manage and turn it off. This book recommends keeping your business context in a text you control and can read (your Business Context Block), because you can see exactly what the assistant is being told. Do not store sensitive personal or customer information in memory or instructions.

File uploads. ChatGPT can accept files, including spreadsheets and documents, subject to size limits, rate limits and per-plan caps. OpenAI's file upload FAQ listed a 512 MB limit per file, while limits on the number of files and the rolling upload rate differ by plan and change. If an upload fails, paste a short sample of the text instead, which is also the safer habit for private material. Uploaded files are kept in your account for as long as the chat is kept; OpenAI states that files from deleted chats are removed within 30 days, with some exceptions.

Data controls and Temporary Chat. In Settings, under Data controls, there is a setting that controls whether your conversations may be used to improve the models (the label has been "Improve the model for everyone"). OpenAI says Temporary Chats are not used for model

training while they stay temporary. Before you paste anything about your business, open these settings, read them, and choose deliberately. Business and enterprise offerings have different terms from personal accounts. If you handle client data, check which kind of account you are using.

Rule that never changes: whatever the feature, you stay responsible for what you send out.

Your first hour

If you read nothing else, do this in 60 minutes:

1. **Minutes 0–10:** Open ChatGPT's data settings and decide what you are comfortable with (see above).
2. **Minutes 10–25:** Run Workflow 1 and save your Business Context Block.
3. **Minutes 25–40:** Pick one email you must answer today. Anonymize it and run Workflow 12.
4. **Minutes 40–55:** Edit the draft until it sounds like you. Note every change you made (those notes tell you what to add to your Business Context Block).
5. **Minutes 55–60:** Save the prompt you used in your prompt library with today's date.

You now have a working, reviewed workflow. The rest of the book repeats that same loop on other jobs.

CHAPTER 2

Prompts and reusable instructions

A prompt is a written brief. A good brief has five elements: **role, context, task, format, limits.** Vague briefs produce generic work. The three workflows here are the foundation for the other 27.

Workflow 1. The Business Context Block

Problem: Every new chat starts from zero, so answers are generic and you keep retyping who you are.
Outcome: One saved paragraph you paste at the start of any chat so outputs sound like your business.
Tools: ChatGPT, a notes app.

Steps

1. Write down answers to the questions in the prompt below.
2. Run the prompt to turn them into a tight block.
3. Save the block. Paste it at the top of future chats.
4. Review and update it every quarter.

Prompt

```
I run a business. Turn my notes into a "Business Context Block"
of no more than 200 words that I can paste at the start of future
chats.
Include: what we sell, who buys, what makes us different, brand
voice (3 adjectives plus 2 words we never use), pricing level
(budget/mid/premium, no exact prices), and rules the assistant
must follow (e.g. never invent facts, ask when unsure).
My notes:
- Business: [WHAT YOU DO]
- Customers: [WHO BUYS AND WHY]
- Different because: [POINTS]
- Voice: [ADJECTIVES / WORDS TO AVOID]
- Rules: [ANY RULES]
```

Example input (fictional): Business: small bakery in Leeds selling custom celebration cakes. Customers: parents and office managers. Different because: gluten-free options, 48-hour turnaround. Voice: warm, honest, plain. Avoid: "artisanal", "indulge".

Example output (shortened): "Brightleaf Bakery makes custom celebration cakes for parents and office teams in Leeds. Our edge: gluten-free options and 48-hour turnaround. Voice: warm, honest, plain; never use 'artisanal' or 'indulge'. Mid-priced. Rules: never invent facts, prices or opening hours; ask if information is missing."

Verify: Every claim is true today. No private data (customer names, bank details). Under 200 words.
Mistakes: Writing marketing slogans instead of facts (fix: facts only). Pasting a 2-page block that dilutes instructions (fix: keep it short).

Workflow 2. The Prompt Improver

Problem: Your prompt gives weak results and you do not know why.
Outcome: A clearer rewritten prompt plus a list of what was missing.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. Copy the prompt that disappointed you.
2. Run the prompt below with your prompt and a sample of the poor output.
3. Test the rewritten version once and compare.
4. Save the better version.

Prompt

```
Act as a prompt coach. Here is a prompt I used and the output I
got.
MY PROMPT: [PASTE]
OUTPUT I GOT: [PASTE A SHORT SAMPLE]
What I actually wanted: [DESCRIBE]
1) List what was missing or unclear in my prompt (role, context,
task, format, limits).
2) Ask me up to 3 questions if you need information.
3) Rewrite my prompt so it is specific and reusable, with
[BRACKETS] for the parts I change each time.
```

Example input: "Write a post about our cakes." Output was a generic 5-emoji caption.
Example output: Missing: audience, platform, length, tone, call to action. Rewritten prompt: "Write one Instagram caption (max 60 words) for [CAKE TYPE] aimed at parents ordering birthday cakes. Warm, plain tone, no emojis, end with a call to order 48 hours ahead."

Verify: The new prompt includes real constraints; one test gave a better result.
Mistakes: Accepting the rewrite untested (fix: run it once). Adding so

many rules that they conflict (fix: keep 5 to 7).

Workflow 3. The Output Format Library

Problem: Answers come as long paragraphs when you need tables, lists or fixed templates.
Outcome: A small set of format instructions you add to any prompt.
Tools: ChatGPT, notes app.

Steps

1. Decide the three formats you use most (table, checklist, email, bullet summary).
2. Run the prompt to generate reusable format lines.
3. Append the matching line to future prompts.

Prompt

```
Create a library of 8 reusable "format instructions" I can append
to any prompt. Each is one or two sentences. Cover: a comparison
table, a checklist with checkboxes, a plain email under 120
words, a 5-bullet summary, a step-by-step numbered procedure, a
table with columns I name, a "pros, cons, recommendation" block,
and a JSON-free plain list. Label each with a short name.
```

Example output: "TABLE: Present the answer as a table with columns [A], [B], [C]. No text outside the table." "EMAIL: Write a plain email under 120 words with a subject line and one clear call to action."

Verify: Each line produces the format when tested once.
Mistakes: Asking for a table and a story together (fix: one format per request).

When the first answer is not right: iterating

The first answer is a draft. Skilled users do not rewrite their whole prompt; they steer with short follow-ups in the same chat. Keep this list beside your prompts:

You want	Follow-up to send
Shorter	"Cut this to 80 words. Keep the offer and the deadline."
More like you	"Rewrite in the voice of my samples above. Remove any phrase I have not used."
Fewer inventions	"List every claim in your answer that was not in my input."
Evidence	"For each point, quote the line of my input that supports it."
Options	"Give me three different versions with different openings."
Better questions	"Before answering, ask me up to 5 questions you need answered."
Hidden assumptions	"What did you assume that I did not tell you?"
A cold read	"Read this as a sceptical customer. What would make you stop reading?"

Example. Prompt: a reply to a customer asking about delivery. The draft promises "next-day delivery". You never said that. Follow-up: "List every claim you made that was not in my facts." The assistant points to "next-day delivery". You delete it and add the real policy. This habit of asking the assistant to audit itself catches many problems, but it is not a guarantee, so the final check is still yours.

When to start a fresh chat. Long chats can drift and earlier instructions can be given less weight. If answers start ignoring your rules, open a new chat, paste your Business Context Block and the task again.

CHAPTER 3

AI-powered market research

An assistant cannot browse your market for you reliably. It can **analyze material you collect**: your own customer messages, reviews, public web page text that you copy in, and your sales notes. This keeps the work grounded and avoids invented facts.

Collecting good input. Research output can only be as good as the text you paste. Spend ten minutes gathering before you prompt, and follow three rules:

1. **Use real text, not your memory of it.** Copy the actual wording of messages and reviews. Customers' own words are the most valuable material you have.
2. **Anonymize first.** Replace names with "Customer A", remove phone numbers, addresses and order numbers.
3. **Batch by theme.** If you have more text than one chat can hold, paste about 20 items at a time, ask for themes for each batch, then paste the batch results together and ask for a combined summary.

Keep a short "source log" (what you pasted, when, where it came from). If someone asks where a conclusion came from, you can answer.

Workflow 4. Customer Persona from Your Own Data

Problem: You describe customers vaguely ("everyone") so marketing is unfocused.
Outcome: One to three evidence-based customer profiles with needs, objections and wording.
Tools: ChatGPT, 10 to 30 real customer messages or order notes (names removed).

Steps

1. Collect real material: emails, DMs, order notes. Remove names and contact details.
2. Paste into the prompt.
3. Read the personas and cross out anything the data does not support.
4. Save to your notes.

Prompt

```
Below are anonymized customer messages and order notes for
[BUSINESS]. Identify up to 3 customer types. For each: who they
are, what they are trying to achieve, top 3 objections, the words
they use, and the evidence (quote a short phrase). Mark anything
you are inferring rather than reading directly as "INFERRED". Do
not invent demographics.
DATA:
[PASTE]
```

Example input: 12 anonymized messages such as "Need a gluten-free cake for Saturday, is that possible?"
Example output: Type 1: Last-minute parents. Goal: a safe cake for a child's party. Objections: lead time, allergy safety. Words: "Saturday", "is that possible". Evidence: quoted phrases. INFERRED: likely time-pressed.

Verify: Each point links to quoted evidence. No stereotypes. No personal data pasted.
Mistakes: Pasting too few messages (fix: 10 or more). Treating INFERRED lines as facts (fix: test them with real customers).

Workflow 5. Competitor Comparison from Pasted Pages

Problem: You do not know how your offer compares.
Outcome: A side-by-side table of what competitors publicly state, with gaps you can use.
Tools: ChatGPT, copied text from 3 to 5 public competitor pages.

Steps

1. Copy the visible text of competitor pages (offers, pricing text, guarantees). Respect each site's terms; copy only what is public and for your own analysis.
2. Paste with your own details.
3. Review the table, then verify any price or claim on the live page.

Prompt

```
Compare my business with these competitors using ONLY the text
below. Create a table: Business | Offer | Price shown |
Promise/guarantee | Who it seems aimed at | Weakness visible in
the text. Then list 3 gaps where my business could stand out, and
say which are supported by the text and which are guesses.
MY BUSINESS: [DETAILS]
COMPETITOR 1: [PASTE]
COMPETITOR 2: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Table row: "Cake Corner | Custom cakes | From £45 | 72-hour notice | Corporate | No gluten-free mentioned." Gap: "Fast-turnaround gluten-free (supported by text)."

Verify: Open each page and confirm prices and claims. Note the date.
Mistakes: Asking it to "find competitors" without sources (fix: you supply the pages). Copying competitor wording (fix: use it for insight only).

Workflow 6. Review and Feedback Theme Analysis

Problem: Dozens of reviews and comments, no clear pattern.
Outcome: Ranked themes with example quotes and suggested actions.
Tools: ChatGPT, exported reviews or survey answers.

Steps

1. Export 20 to 100 reviews or answers; remove names.
2. Paste in batches if long.
3. Check counts by hand for the top two themes.
4. Choose one improvement to test.

Prompt

```
Analyze these customer reviews for [BUSINESS]. Group them into
themes. For each theme: a name, how many reviews mention it
(count carefully), 2 short example quotes, and whether it is
positive or negative. Rank by frequency. Then suggest 3 practical
actions. If counts are uncertain, say so.
REVIEWS:
[PASTE]
```

Example output: "Theme: Fast delivery (positive), 9 of 30. Quote: 'arrived next day'. Theme: Packaging damaged (negative), 4 of 30. Action: test sturdier boxes."

Verify: Re-count two themes yourself. Confirm quotes exist.
Mistakes: Trusting counts blindly (fix: spot-check). Mixing different products in one batch (fix: separate them).

CHAPTER 4

Marketing content and social media

AI helps with volume and structure. Your job is truth, taste and brand voice. Always include your Business Context Block (Workflow 1).

Workflow 7. Monthly Content Calendar

Problem: You post inconsistently because you never plan.
Outcome: A 4-week calendar with topics, formats and goals.
Tools: ChatGPT, spreadsheet.

Steps

1. Paste your context block and list real events, offers and launches this month.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Edit out ideas you cannot deliver.
4. Paste the final table into your spreadsheet.

Prompt

```
[PASTE BUSINESS CONTEXT BLOCK]
Create a 4-week content calendar for [PLATFORMS]. I can post
[NUMBER] times per week. Real events this month: [LIST]. Table
columns: Week | Day | Platform | Topic | Format | Goal
(awareness/trust/sale) | Call to action. Mix education, behind-
the-scenes, customer proof I actually have, and offers. Do not
invent customer stories or statistics.
```

Example output: "Week 1 | Tue | Instagram | How we make gluten-free sponge | Short video | Trust | Order 48 hours ahead."

Verify: Every item is doable. Nothing claims proof you do not have.
Mistakes: Too many posts per week (fix: set a realistic number). Generic topics (fix: add real events).

Workflow 8. One Piece, Five Formats

Problem: Making new content every time is exhausting.
Outcome: One idea turned into email, social posts, a short script and a FAQ.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. Choose one source (a blog post, a tip, a product story).
2. Paste it with the target formats.
3. Edit each output for the platform and your voice.

Prompt

```
[PASTE BUSINESS CONTEXT BLOCK]
Turn the source below into: (1) a 100-word email, (2) a LinkedIn
post of 120 words, (3) three short social captions, (4) a 30-
second video script, (5) two FAQ entries. Keep facts exactly as
in the source; add none.
SOURCE: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Five short pieces with consistent facts and a different tone per channel.

Verify: Facts match the source word for word where it matters (dates, prices, claims).
Mistakes: Posting all five on one day (fix: schedule across the week).

Workflow 9. Social Post Batch in Your Voice

Problem: Posts sound generic or like AI.
Outcome: A batch of drafts matched to your real voice samples.
Tools: ChatGPT, 3 examples of your best past writing.

Steps

1. Paste 3 samples of writing you like.
2. Ask the assistant to describe your voice first.
3. Generate posts using that description.
4. Edit lightly and add your own details.

Prompt

```
Here are 3 samples of my writing: [PASTE]. First describe my
voice in 5 bullets (sentence length, vocabulary, humor, openings,
endings). Then write 6 posts about [TOPIC] for [PLATFORM] in that
voice. Under 70 words each. No hashtags unless I ask. Do not add
facts I have not given.
```

Example output: Voice: short sentences, dry humor, starts with a question. Then six drafts.

Verify: Would you say this out loud? Remove clichés and unsupported claims.
Mistakes: Skipping the voice description (fix: it is the main quality driver).

Workflow 10. Blog or Guide Brief and Draft

Problem: Blank page, vague outline.
Outcome: A search-friendly brief, then a first draft you rewrite.
Tools: ChatGPT, your expertise.

Steps

1. Choose a question customers really ask.
2. Run the brief prompt and adjust the outline.
3. Run the draft prompt section by section.
4. Add your own examples and verify facts.

Prompt

```
[PASTE BUSINESS CONTEXT BLOCK]
Brief for an article answering: "[CUSTOMER QUESTION]". Give:
working title, search intent in one sentence, reader level,
outline with 5 to 7 headings, points that need my own expertise
(mark "ADD MY EXAMPLE"), and facts that must be checked (mark
"VERIFY"). Then wait for me to approve before drafting.
```

Example output: Outline with "ADD MY EXAMPLE" and "VERIFY: allergen labelling rules in the UK".

Verify: Every VERIFY item is checked against an official source. Add your real examples.
Mistakes: Publishing the raw draft (fix: AI text should be a starting point only).

Keeping marketing content honest and on-brand

Generated marketing copy tends to sound confident whether or not it is true. Use a **two-pass edit** on everything you publish:

- **Pass 1: facts.** Underline every number, date, price, claim and name. Check each one against your records. Delete any statement you cannot support (for example "trusted by thousands" or "the best in town").
- **Pass 2: voice.** Read it aloud. Remove phrases you would never say. Replace generic words with specific details from your business.

Before and after (illustrative).
Draft: "Indulge in our artisanal, award-winning cakes, loved by thousands!"
Problems: "indulge" and "artisanal" are on the banned list; "award-winning" and "thousands" are unsupported.
Edited: "Gluten-free celebration cakes, made in Leeds, ready in 48 hours. Order by Thursday for a Saturday party."

Also check the rules that apply to you: advertising standards, endorsement and review rules, and each platform's policies. Never post invented testimonials, and never present AI-generated images or text as real customer evidence.

CHAPTER 5

Email and customer communication

Email is where tone mistakes cost money. Use AI for structure and speed, then read every message as the customer would.

The tone ladder. Decide the tone before you prompt. Four settings cover most business email: *warm and brief* (routine replies), *formal and precise* (contracts, invoices), *firm and calm* (late payment, boundaries), and *apologetic and practical* (something went wrong). Put the chosen setting in the prompt in one line, for example "Tone: firm and calm; no threats; keep the deadline."

Before and after (illustrative).
Draft: "As per my previous email, you still have not paid. This is unacceptable."
Revised: "Hi Sam, invoice 1042 for £180 was due on 1 November and is still open. Could you pay by Friday 14 November, or tell me if there is a problem? Thank you."
What changed: the facts (invoice, amount, dates) stayed; the blame went; a clear next step appeared.

One rule for every email: the assistant may draft, but it never sends. You press send.

Workflow 11. Welcome Email Sequence

Problem: New subscribers or customers hear nothing, or get one generic email.
Outcome: A 4-email welcome sequence with clear purpose per email.
Tools: ChatGPT, your email tool.

Steps

1. Paste your context block and your real offer.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Replace placeholders; add real links.
4. Load into your email tool and test-send to yourself.

Prompt

```
[PASTE BUSINESS CONTEXT BLOCK]
Write a 4-email welcome sequence for new [SUBSCRIBERS/CUSTOMERS].
For each: day to send, subject line (under 50 characters),
purpose, body under 150 words, one call to action. Email 1: thank
and set expectations. Email 2: useful tip. Email 3: how customers
use our [PRODUCT]. Email 4: gentle offer: [REAL OFFER]. No fake
urgency, no invented testimonials.
```

Example output: Four short emails, each with one CTA, e.g. "Subject: Your first order, simplified".

Verify: Links, offer terms and dates are real. Unsubscribe link and sender details are present as your local law requires.
Mistakes: Fake scarcity ("only 2 left") (fix: only say true things). Long emails (fix: one idea each).

Workflow 12. Customer Email Reply Drafter

Problem: Inbox replies take hours.
Outcome: Accurate, polite draft replies in two minutes each.
Tools: ChatGPT, your policies.

Steps

1. Remove personal identifiers from the customer's email.
2. Paste with your facts (policy, price, dates).
3. Edit the draft, restore the name, send.

Prompt

```
[PASTE BUSINESS CONTEXT BLOCK]
Draft a reply to this customer email. Use ONLY these facts:
[POLICY/PRICE/DATES]. If the email asks about something not in my
facts, write "[NEED INFO: ...]" instead of guessing. Tone: warm,
brief, under 120 words.
CUSTOMER EMAIL (names removed): [PASTE]
```

Example input: "Can I change my order date? It's for Saturday." Facts: changes free up to 48 hours before.
Example output: "Thanks for getting in touch. Yes, we can change the date free of charge up to 48 hours before collection. Which new date works? [NEED INFO: confirm availability]".

Verify: Every fact in the reply is from your list. NEED INFO tags are resolved.
Mistakes: Letting the assistant promise refunds or deadlines (fix: facts list only).

Workflow 13. Newsletter from Rough Notes

Problem: You have notes but no time to write the newsletter.
Outcome: A structured newsletter draft in your voice.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. Dump rough bullets: news, a tip, one offer.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Edit for voice and truth; add links.

Prompt

```
[PASTE BUSINESS CONTEXT BLOCK]
Turn my notes into a newsletter: subject line options (3), a 2-sentence opening, three short sections with headings, one call to action. Under 300 words. Use only the facts in my notes.
NOTES: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Three subject options, an opening, sections ("This month", "One tip", "Offer").

Verify: Dates, prices and links. Remove anything you did not say.
Mistakes: Adding extra claims (fix: "use only my notes").

Workflow 14. Difficult Message Tone Check

Problem: A complaint, late payment or refusal needs care.
Outcome: A calm, firm message that protects the relationship.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. Write your honest first draft, even if blunt.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Read the final aloud.
4. Check with a second person for serious cases.

Prompt

```
Here is my draft message and the situation. Rewrite it to be
polite, clear and firm. Keep all factual statements and deadlines
unchanged. Do not add apologies I did not intend or promises I
did not make. Then list any sentences that could be read as
threatening or legally risky.
SITUATION: [SHORT]
DRAFT: [PASTE]
```

Example output: A calmer version plus a note: "'We will take action' may sound like a threat; consider naming the exact step."

Verify: Facts, amounts and dates unchanged. Legal or contractual issues go to a qualified professional.
Mistakes: Letting AI soften a deadline (fix: check dates). Sending in anger (fix: wait an hour).

CHAPTER 6

Sales prospecting and lead-generation workflows

Use these for **genuine, relevant outreach** to people who plausibly need your service. Follow the rules that apply to you for email, messaging and data protection in your country. Never scrape personal data in ways a platform forbids.

Keep a simple tracker. Outreach only works when you can see what you did. Use one spreadsheet with these columns: *Name or company* | *Role* | *Source of the real detail* | *Date first contacted* | *Message version* | *Follow-up 1 date* | *Follow-up 2 date* | *Follow-up 3 date* | *Reply (yes/no/stop)* | *Next action*. Set a daily cap you can personally review, for example five to ten messages. If you cannot read every message before it goes, you are sending too many.

Measure what you can. After 30 messages, count how many replied and which message version they replied to. Ask the assistant to compare two versions only using your counts, and treat small numbers as a hint, not a conclusion.

Workflow 15. Ideal Lead Profile and Search Criteria

Problem: You contact random people, so replies are rare.
Outcome: A one-page lead profile and a checklist for qualifying leads.
Tools: ChatGPT, your best past customers.

Steps

1. Describe 3 to 5 of your best customers (no private data).
2. Run the prompt.
3. Turn the result into a spreadsheet checklist.

Prompt

```
From these descriptions of my best customers, create an ideal
lead profile: industry, size, trigger events that create need,
roles to contact, signs they are a good fit, signs to avoid. Then
give 10 qualifying questions. Mark anything you assumed as
"ASSUMED".
CUSTOMERS: [DESCRIBE]
```

Example output: Profile: "Offices of 10 to 50 staff, event trigger: staff birthdays or client visits. Contact: office manager. Avoid: one-off buyers without repeat potential."

Verify: Compare with your real sales history. Remove ASSUMED lines you cannot support.
Mistakes: Profile too broad (fix: add one more filter).

Workflow 16. Personalized Outreach Draft

Problem: Templates feel spammy; fully custom messages take too long.
Outcome: A short message personalized with one real detail.
Tools: ChatGPT, a real fact about the prospect from their public page.

Steps

1. Find one relevant public fact (recent post, new location).
2. Paste with your offer.
3. Edit so it sounds like you; send manually.

Prompt

```
Write a first outreach message, under 90 words, to [ROLE] at
[COMPANY TYPE]. Use this real detail about them: [FACT]. Offer:
[WHAT I DO AND WHY IT MIGHT HELP]. One clear low-pressure
question at the end. No flattery, no false claims, no pretending
we have met.
```

Example output: "Hi Priya, I saw your team just moved to a new office. We make boxed celebration cakes for small teams. Would a sample box for your move-in week be useful?"

Verify: The detail is accurate. The message is honest and relevant. You comply with local rules on unsolicited messages.
Mistakes: Fake familiarity (fix: only real details). Mass-sending without review (fix: send in small batches).

Workflow 17. Follow-Up Sequence

Problem: You send one message and give up.
Outcome: Three polite follow-ups at sensible intervals.
Tools: ChatGPT, spreadsheet.

Steps

1. Paste your first message.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Record send dates in your tracker; stop if they decline.

Prompt

```
Based on my first message below, write 3 follow-ups: day 3, day
7, day 14. Each under 60 words, each adds something new (a
helpful tip, a question, a graceful close). The last one makes it
easy to say no. No guilt, no fake deadlines.
FIRST MESSAGE: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Follow-up 3: "Last note from me. If this isn't a priority, no problem at all, and I'll leave it there."

Verify: Honors opt-outs. No new claims you cannot support.
Mistakes: Continuing after "no" (fix: stop immediately).

Workflow 18. Call Prep Brief and Post-Call Summary

Problem: You go into calls unprepared and forget follow-ups.
Outcome: A one-page brief before and a clean summary after.
Tools: ChatGPT, your call notes.

Steps

1. Before: paste what you know; get questions and risks.
2. After: paste your rough notes.
3. Send the summary to the client after checking.

Prompt (before)

```
I have a call with [ROLE/COMPANY TYPE]. Known: [NOTES]. Give me:
goal for the call, 8 discovery questions, 3 likely objections
with honest answers, and what I should not promise.
```

Prompt (after)

```
Turn these call notes into a summary email: what was discussed,
what was agreed, next steps with owners and dates, open
questions. Use only my notes. Mark gaps as [CONFIRM].
NOTES: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Summary with "Next step: send sample list by Friday (me)" and "[CONFIRM: delivery address]".

Verify: Agreed items match what was actually said. Confirm all [CONFIRM] tags.
Mistakes: Recording calls without consent (fix: ask first and follow local law).

CHAPTER 7

Customer service and FAQ automation

"Automation" here means faster, more consistent human replies, not an unsupervised bot. If you do use an automated chat on your site, test it heavily and tell users they are talking to automation where required.

Where AI should not answer customers alone. Keep a person in charge of refunds and compensation, safety, allergy, health or legal questions, complaints that mention a regulator or lawyer, and any message from someone who seems distressed. Write this list down in your reply macros so a helper knows when to stop and escalate.

Maintain the knowledge base. An FAQ or macro library goes out of date quickly. Once a month, spend 20 minutes: paste the last month's new questions, ask the assistant which are not covered by your FAQ, add approved answers yourself, and update the "last reviewed" date.

Workflow 19. FAQ Builder

Problem: The same questions arrive daily.
Outcome: A clear FAQ page with approved answers.
Tools: ChatGPT, your last 30 customer questions.

Steps

1. List repeated questions (anonymized).
2. Add the true answer for each.
3. Run the prompt.
4. Publish after review.

Prompt

```
Create an FAQ for [BUSINESS] from these questions and my approved
answers. Group by topic. Keep each answer under 60 words, plain
English, using only my answers. If an answer is missing, write "
[NEED ANSWER]".
QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS: [PASTE]
```

Example output: "Delivery. How fast? Orders ship within 2 working days."

Verify: Each answer matches your current policy. Update the date.
Mistakes: Letting AI fill missing answers (fix: NEED ANSWER tags).

Workflow 20. Reply Macro Library

Problem: Support replies vary in quality.
Outcome: 10 to 15 reusable reply templates with variables.
Tools: ChatGPT, helpdesk or notes app.

Steps

1. List the 10 most common reply situations.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Store templates; fill variables each time.

Prompt

```
Create reply templates for these situations: [LIST]. Each: name,
when to use, template under 100 words with [VARIABLES], and a
"check before sending" line. Use my policies only: [POLICIES].
```

Example output: "Late delivery | Use when courier delay | 'Sorry your order is late...' | Check: tracking status."

Verify: Every promise in a template is one you can keep.
Mistakes: Templates that sound robotic (fix: add one personal line each time).

Workflow 21. Complaint Triage and Response Plan

Problem: Angry messages are stressful and easy to mishandle.
Outcome: A calm analysis, a draft reply and an internal action list.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. Remove names; paste the complaint and facts.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Decide the remedy yourself.
4. Send, then log the lesson.

Prompt

```
Analyze this complaint. 1) What happened, what the customer
wants, severity (low/medium/high) with a reason. 2) A draft reply
under 130 words that acknowledges the issue without admitting
facts I have not confirmed. 3) Internal actions. Facts I
confirmed: [FACTS]. Remedy I am willing to offer: [REMEDY].
COMPLAINT: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Severity medium; reply offers the confirmed remedy; internal action: check packaging process.

Verify: Reply offers only what you decided. Serious safety, legal or health matters go to a professional.
Mistakes: Admitting liability by accident (fix: stick to confirmed facts).

CHAPTER 8

Business administration and documentation

Admin work is full of documents that follow a pattern: minutes, proposals, role descriptions, policies. Patterns are where AI helps most. The risk is that documents carry commitments (money, dates, legal duties), so numbers and terms must always come from you. A good habit is to give every document a consistent name and a version date (for example "Proposal Brightleaf v2 2026-11-07") and to save the prompt that produced it beside it, so you can reproduce or improve it later.

Workflow 22. Meeting Notes to Action Items

Problem: Meetings end with no clear owners.
Outcome: A summary with decisions, actions, owners and dates.
Tools: ChatGPT, notes or a transcript you have permission to use.

Steps

1. Paste notes (no confidential content beyond what is needed).
2. Run the prompt.
3. Send for correction by attendees.

Prompt

```
From these notes produce: decisions made, action items (task | owner | due date), open questions, next meeting topics. If an owner or date is missing, write [UNASSIGNED] or [NO DATE]. Do not guess.
NOTES: [PASTE]
```

Example output: "Order new boxes | Sam | 14 Nov", "Review pricing | [UNASSIGNED] | [NO DATE]".

Verify: Attendees confirm decisions.
Mistakes: Guessing owners (fix: keep UNASSIGNED tags).

Workflow 23. Proposal and Quote Draft

Problem: Proposals take too long and vary in quality.
Outcome: A clear, structured proposal with scope and exclusions.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. List client needs, scope, price and terms from your own decisions.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Check numbers; have contract terms reviewed where needed.

Prompt

```
Draft a proposal. Sections: summary of the client's need, what I will deliver, what is not included, timeline, price as given, next step. Plain, professional tone, under 500 words. Use only these facts: [FACTS]. Do not add legal terms or guarantees.
```

Example output: A one-page proposal with an "Not included" section.

Verify: Price, dates and scope are exactly yours. Legal terms come from a qualified source.
Mistakes: Vague scope (fix: list exclusions).

Workflow 24. Job Description and Policy Drafts

Problem: You need written role descriptions or simple internal policies.
Outcome: A clean first draft to review.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. List real duties, requirements and hours.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Check local employment rules before use; policies affecting staff rights need professional review.

Prompt

```
Draft a job description for [ROLE] at [BUSINESS]. Sections:
summary, responsibilities (6 to 8), requirements split into "must
have" and "nice to have", working pattern, how to apply. Use only
my facts: [FACTS]. Avoid requirements that are not truly needed.
Do not mention salary unless I give it.
```

Example output: A one-page description with must-have and nice-to-have separated.

Verify: No discriminatory wording. Complies with local employment law. Pay and hours are exact.
Mistakes: Copying a policy that does not match local law (fix: professional review).

CHAPTER 9

Spreadsheets, reports and data organization

Do not paste sensitive data. Use sample rows or anonymized columns. Always test formulas on a copy.

Safe data habits for spreadsheets.

1. Work on a duplicate of the file and keep the original untouched.
2. Share only a handful of sample rows with the assistant, with names and contact details removed. The assistant needs the shape of your data, not all of it.
3. Check totals by hand. Pick three rows or one subtotal and calculate it yourself before trusting a formula or a summary.
4. Write down what you changed (the rule, not every cell) so you can repeat it next month.

Worked check (illustrative). The assistant says orders grew from 80 to 92. Check: 92 − 80 = 12; 12 ÷ 80 = 0.15, which is 15%. If the assistant had said 12%, you would catch the error because you did the sum yourself.

Workflow 25. Messy List Cleaner

Problem: A contact or product list has inconsistent formatting.
Outcome: A cleaning plan and a cleaned sample.
Tools: ChatGPT, spreadsheet.

Steps

1. Paste 20 anonymized sample rows.
2. Run the prompt to get rules.
3. Apply rules in the spreadsheet (find and replace, formulas).
4. Spot-check 20 rows.

Prompt

```
Here are sample rows from a spreadsheet. Identify formatting
problems (case, spaces, date formats, duplicates, mixed units).
Propose cleaning rules and show the cleaned version of the
sample. Do not change values unless the rule is stated.
SAMPLE: [PASTE]
```

Example output: "Rule: trim spaces and convert 'LEEDS', 'leeds' to 'Leeds'."

Verify: Compare before and after on a copy. Keep the original.
Mistakes: Cleaning the only copy (fix: duplicate first).

Workflow 26. Spreadsheet Formula Helper

Problem: You know what you need but not the formula.
Outcome: A working formula with an explanation and tests.
Tools: ChatGPT, your spreadsheet app.

Steps

1. Describe columns and goal.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Test on 3 rows you can check by hand.

Prompt

```
I use [EXCEL/GOOGLE SHEETS]. Columns: A = [..], B = [..], C =
[..]. Goal: [DESCRIBE]. Give the formula for cell [CELL], explain
it in plain English, and give 3 test cases with expected results.
Note if functions differ between apps.
```

Example input: Excel. Columns: A = City, B = Order date, C = Amount. Goal: total amount for Leeds orders from 1 November 2026 onwards, in cell E2.
Example output: `=SUMIFS(C:C, A:A, "Leeds", B:B, ">="&DATE(2026,11,1))`, explained as "add column C where column A is Leeds and column B is on or after 1 Nov 2026", plus three test rows with the expected totals.

Verify: Run the 3 tests. Check edge cases such as blanks.
Mistakes: Trusting a formula untested (fix: test cases).

Workflow 27. Monthly Numbers to Plain-English Report

Problem: You have numbers but no narrative.
Outcome: A one-page summary of what changed and what to check.
Tools: ChatGPT, your monthly figures.

Steps

1. Paste a small table of figures.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Check every number against the table.

Prompt

```
Here are this month's and last month's figures. Write a one-page
summary: key changes (with exact numbers and percentage change
calculated step by step), possible reasons clearly labeled as
hypotheses, questions to investigate, and 3 next steps. Do not
state causes as facts.
FIGURES: [PASTE]
```

Example output: "Orders rose from 80 to 92 (+15%). Hypothesis: seasonal events. Question: which products drove it?"

Verify: Recalculate each percentage yourself.
Mistakes: Accepting causes as facts (fix: they are hypotheses).

CHAPTER 10

Reusable workflows and SOPs

A **standard operating procedure (SOP)** is a written way to do a recurring task so anyone can repeat it. AI is good at turning rough, spoken knowledge into clear steps. You supply the truth; it supplies the structure.

The new-hire test. An SOP is finished only when someone who has never done the task can follow it without asking you a question. Hand the draft to that person, watch (do not help), and mark every point where they hesitate. Each hesitation is a missing detail. Ask the assistant to rewrite only the unclear steps.

Before and after (illustrative).
Rough note: "Check the order and sort the allergy thing."
SOP step: "3. Open the order form. If the 'Allergies' box contains text, write the allergy in red on the kitchen board and move the order to the allergen-safe prep area. If the box is empty, continue to step 4."
What improved: one action per step, a clear condition, a named place, and a next step for both cases.

Workflow 28. SOP Builder

Problem: Key tasks live in one person's head.
Outcome: A clear SOP with purpose, steps, owner, tools and quality check.
Tools: ChatGPT.

Steps

1. Do the task once and write rough notes of what you actually did.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Ask someone else to follow the SOP and note where they get stuck.
4. Fix and date the SOP.

Prompt

```
Turn my rough notes into an SOP. Sections: purpose, when to use,
who does it, tools needed, numbered steps (one action per step),
common mistakes, quality check, last reviewed date. Mark any step
where my notes are unclear as "[CLARIFY]". Do not add steps I did
not describe.
NOTES: [PASTE]
```

Example input: "Order comes in, check the allergy box, write it on the board, confirm by email, bake day before..."
Example output: Numbered SOP with "Step 2: Check the allergy box. If ticked, move to the allergen-safe prep area."

Verify: Someone new can follow it without asking you.
Mistakes: Steps with several actions (fix: one action per step).

Workflow 29. Checklist and Quick-Training Guide

Problem: New helpers need training, and checklists get skipped.
Outcome: A one-page checklist plus a short training guide.
Tools: ChatGPT, your SOP.

Steps

1. Paste the SOP.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Test with a new person.

Prompt

```
From this SOP create: (1) a one-page checklist with checkboxes,
(2) a 10-minute training outline for a new team member including
5 quiz questions with answers, (3) a list of 3 things that most
often go wrong. Use only the SOP.
SOP: [PASTE]
```

Example output: Checklist plus quiz: "What do you do if the allergy box is ticked?"

Verify: Quiz answers match the SOP exactly.
Mistakes: Long checklists nobody uses (fix: keep to one page).

Workflow 30. Workflow Audit: What Should I Automate?

Problem: You do not know which tasks deserve AI help.
Outcome: A ranked list of tasks by time saved, risk and effort.
Tools: ChatGPT, a list of your weekly tasks.

Steps

1. List weekly tasks with rough minutes.
2. Run the prompt.
3. Pick the top two and apply the matching workflow.
4. Re-run the audit after 30 days.

Prompt

```
Here are my recurring tasks with minutes per week. For each,
rate: AI suitability (high/medium/low), risk if the output is
wrong (low/medium/high), and effort to set up. Rank the top 5 to
try first. Suggest a human check for each. Say which tasks should
stay fully human.
TASKS: [PASTE]
```

Example output: "Reply to routine emails | 180 min | High | Medium | Low effort. Rank 1. Pricing decisions: keep human."

Verify: You agree with the risk ratings. High-risk tasks keep a person in charge.
Mistakes: Starting with the riskiest task (fix: start with low-risk drafting).

CHAPTER 11

Safety, privacy, accuracy and human review

Privacy rules of thumb

1. **Do not paste what you would not email to a stranger**: passwords, payment details, medical or other special-category data, confidential contracts, and customers' personal details.
2. **Anonymize first**: replace names with "Customer A", remove phone numbers and addresses.
3. **Know your settings.** Data controls, retention and training options differ by product and plan. Read the provider's privacy information and your account settings.
4. **Follow the law and contracts** that apply to you (for example data-protection rules and client confidentiality terms). Ask a qualified professional when unsure.

What to check in your account (as documented 7 November 2026)

OpenAI's help pages describe these controls. Names and locations change, so look for the equivalent in your own settings.

- **Data controls:** a setting that decides whether your conversations may be used to improve the models. Turning it off does not delete your saved chats.

- **Temporary Chat:** conversations that OpenAI says are not used for training while they remain temporary. Use these for anything you would rather not keep. If you save one, it becomes a normal chat under your normal settings.
- **Memory:** information the assistant can keep between chats. You can review and delete it, and turn it off.
- **Chat and file retention:** files uploaded in a chat are kept as long as that chat is kept; OpenAI states that files from deleted chats are removed within 30 days, with exceptions.
- **Account type:** personal, team, business and enterprise accounts can have different data terms. If you work with client or employee data, confirm which terms apply to you.

Write the date you checked these on Worksheet 4 and check again every quarter.

A one-page AI use policy for a small business (template)

Copy this into a document, edit it, and share it with anyone who helps you.

```
AI USE POLICY - [BUSINESS] - Reviewed [DATE]
1. We use AI to draft and organize. A person approves everything
before it is sent or published.
2. We never paste: passwords, payment details, health
information, identity documents, or customers' personal details.
3. We anonymize examples (Customer A, Supplier B) before pasting
them.
4. We check every number, date, price, name and claim against our
records.
5. We never publish invented testimonials, reviews or case
studies.
6. We do not use AI for final decisions on pricing, hiring,
legal, tax, medical or safety matters.
7. We tell customers when they are talking to an automated tool,
where required.
8. Questions or mistakes go to: [NAME]. We review this policy
every quarter.
```

This template is a starting point, not legal advice. If you employ people or hold sensitive data, ask a qualified adviser to review it.

Accuracy rules

- Treat every number, date, price, quote, law, citation and statistic as **unverified until you check it**.
- Ask the assistant to mark uncertainty, but do not rely on its self-assessment.
- Never publish invented testimonials, case studies or reviews.
- Keep a source for each factual claim in marketing.

The human review ladder

Risk level	Examples	Review
Low	Brainstorming, internal outlines	Quick read
Medium	Social posts, routine customer replies	Read fully, check facts
High	Pricing, contracts, legal, health, finance, HR, safety	Professional or second-person review; AI only for structure

Honesty with customers

Check the rules that apply to you about disclosing AI use, advertising claims and endorsements. Where a customer talks to an automated tool, do not pretend it is a person.

A personal pre-send checklist

- [ ] Facts correct and sourced
- [ ] Nothing promised that I cannot deliver
- [ ] No private data included
- [ ] Sounds like me
- [ ] I would be comfortable if the customer knew AI helped

CHAPTER 12

Your 30-day implementation plan

The aim is **one new habit at a time**. Spend 20 to 40 minutes a day.

Week 1: Foundations

- Day 1: Workflow 1 (Business Context Block). Save it.
- Day 2: Workflow 3 (format library).
- Day 3: Workflow 30 (audit your tasks).
- Day 4: Read Chapter 11. Write your own privacy rules.
- Day 5: Workflow 2 (improve one prompt that failed).
- Day 6–7: Rest and review. Pick your three biggest time-sinks.

Week 2: Communication

- Day 8: Workflow 12 (reply drafter) for five real emails.
- Day 9: Workflow 20 (reply macros).
- Day 10: Workflow 19 (FAQ builder).
- Day 11: Workflow 13 (newsletter).
- Day 12: Workflow 14 (difficult message).
- Day 13–14: Review time saved and errors caught.

Week 3: Marketing and research

- Day 15: Workflow 6 (review themes).
- Day 16: Workflow 4 (customer personas).
- Day 17: Workflow 7 (content calendar).

- Day 18: Workflow 9 (voice and post batch).
- Day 19: Workflow 8 (one piece, five formats).
- Day 20–21: Publish a small batch; note what you edited most.

Week 4: Sales, admin and systems

- Day 22: Workflow 15 (lead profile).
- Day 23: Workflow 16 and 17 (outreach and follow-ups) to a small, relevant list.
- Day 24: Workflow 22 (meeting actions).
- Day 25: Workflow 27 (monthly numbers).
- Day 26: Workflow 28 (one SOP).
- Day 27: Workflow 29 (checklist and training).
- Day 28: Workflow 30 again; compare with Day 3.
- Day 29: Update your Business Context Block and prompt library.
- Day 30: Decide what to keep, drop or expand. Write your next 30-day goal.

Workflows 5, 10, 11, 18, 21, 23, 24, 25 and 26 are on-demand: use them when the need arises.

A worked example of week 1 (fictional)

Brightleaf Bakery has two people and a shared inbox. The owner, Dana, has about 90 minutes a week she wants back from email.

- **Day 1 (25 minutes).** Dana runs Workflow 1 and saves a 150-word context block. She checks her data settings and decides to use Temporary Chat for anything that mentions a customer's order.
- **Day 2 (30 minutes).** She lists her tasks for Workflow 30. Email replies take about 180 minutes a week, so they rank first.
- **Day 3 (30 minutes).** She runs Workflow 12 on four anonymized emails. She changes two drafts: one promised a delivery time she had not given, one used the banned word "indulge". She adds both to her context block as rules.

- **Day 4 (20 minutes).** She runs Workflow 3 and saves two format lines: "plain email under 120 words" and "5-bullet summary".
- **Day 5 (30 minutes).** She runs Workflow 2 on a social-post prompt that gave generic results, and saves the improved version.
- **Day 6 (15 minutes).** She records, on Worksheet 3, time before and after for each workflow, and what she edited.

At the end of week 1 she has a context block, three saved prompts, two new rules and an honest note of what saved time and what did not. She has not published anything she has not read, and she has not pasted any private data. That is the standard this plan is built to teach.

Appendix A. Prompt library index

Keep every prompt you use in one document with a name, date and "last tested" note. Suggested folders:

Folder	Workflows
Foundations	1, 2, 3
Research	4, 5, 6
Marketing	7, 8, 9, 10
Email	11, 12, 13, 14
Sales	15, 16, 17, 18
Customer service	19, 20, 21
Admin	22, 23, 24
Data and reports	25, 26, 27
Systems	28, 29, 30

Naming format: `[Folder] Name v1 – tested 2026-11-07`

Prompt template (use for any new task):

```
ROLE: Act as [role].
CONTEXT: [Business Context Block + situation]
TASK: [one clear task]
INPUT: [material, anonymized]
FORMAT: [format instruction]
```

```
LIMITS: Use only the facts given. Mark unknowns as [NEED INFO].
Do not invent statistics, quotes or testimonials.
```

Appendix B. Worksheets

Worksheet 1. Weekly task audit

Task	Minutes/week	AI suitable?	Risk if wrong	Workflow #	Owner

Worksheet 2. Business context notes

- What we sell:
- Who buys and why:
- What makes us different (facts only):
- Voice: 3 adjectives / 2 words never used:
- Rules for the assistant:

Worksheet 3. Workflow test log

Date	Workflow	Time before	Time after	Edits needed	Errors caught	Keep?

Worksheet 4. Privacy rules

- Data I never paste:
- How I anonymize:
- Who may use AI in my business:
- Settings checked on (date):

Worksheet 5. Review ladder

Output type	Risk (L/M/H)	Who reviews	Checklist used

Worksheet 6. 30-day scorecard

Week	Workflows tried	Hours saved (estimate)	Biggest lesson	Next step

Appendix C. Glossary

- **Assistant / chatbot:** software you talk to in plain language.
- **Prompt:** the instruction and material you give the assistant.
- **Context:** the information the assistant can use in the current conversation.
- **Hallucination:** a confident statement that is false or unsupported.
- **Anonymize:** remove details that identify a person.
- **SOP:** standard operating procedure; a written repeatable method.
- **Workflow:** a repeatable sequence from input to checked output.
- **Verification checklist:** the human checks done before output is used.
- **Placeholder:** text in [BRACKETS] you replace.
- **Human in the loop:** a person reviews and approves before use.

Appendix D. References and further learning

Research dates: 7 November 2026. Web pages change; check the current version before relying on a detail. No statistics are quoted in this book.

OpenAI Help Center (features, data controls, privacy)

- Data controls in ChatGPT: https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7730893-data-controls-in-chatgpt
- How your data is used to improve model performance: https://help.openai.com/en/articles/5722486-how-your-data-is-used-to-improve-model-performance
- Memory in ChatGPT: https://help.openai.com/en/articles/8590148-memory-in-chatgpt
- File uploads FAQ: https://help.openai.com/en/articles/8555545-file-uploads-faq
- Projects in ChatGPT: https://help.openai.com/en/articles/10169521-projects-in-chatgpt

Other guidance to read in your own country

- Your national data protection authority (for example the UK Information Commissioner's Office) for personal data rules.

- Your advertising standards or consumer protection body for rules on advertising claims, endorsements and reviews.
- Your email and messaging regulations for marketing communications.
- Your accountant, lawyer or HR adviser for contracts, tax, employment and compliance questions.

Note: the OpenAI pages above were reached through search results on 7 November 2026; some could not be opened directly by the author's tool (access blocked), so details such as limits and menu names should be confirmed in your own account.